



To: Yi-An Huang, City Manager

From: Melissa Peters, Assistant City Manager for Community Development

Date: July 24, 2026

Re: **Revised Massachusetts Avenue Active Use Zoning Petition**

We are pleased to transmit the attached revised Massachusetts Avenue Active Use Zoning Petition for the Council's consideration. This revision comes at the end of the required public hearing phase for the petition, which included a hearing at the Planning Board on June 2, 2026, and two meetings of the Ordinance Committee on June 16 and July 7, 2026. The Planning Board voted to forward a report with no recommendation to the City Council, which was transmitted on June 22, 2026. The revisions reflect the changes discussed and approved by the Ordinance Committee at its meeting on July 7, 2026.

Summary of Revisions

- Revised Zoning Map and Map Description to maintain existing MAS-12 zoning designation north of Porter Square, requiring ground story active uses in new buildings taller than 8 stories above grade.
- No ordinance text amendments needed.

Next Steps

If the City Council chooses to accept the proposed changes, it can vote to amend the petition by substitution before passing it to a second reading at the August 3, 2026 meeting, which would allow the Council to take final action on September 14, 2026. The petition will expire on September 14, 2026.